

KAALAM

CD23731 - FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING

REPORT

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PRIYADHARSHINI S - 231701040

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Report titled " KAALAM " is the bonafide work of PRIYADHARSHINI S (231701040) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

Signature of the HOD

Dr. S. Vinodh Kumar

Professor and Head

Department of Computer Science and Design

Rajalakshmi Engineering College, Chennai

Signature of the Supervisor

Dr. Gunasekar S

Associate Professor

Department of Computer Science and Design

Rajalakshmi Engineering College, Chennai

Signature of Internal Examiner

Signature of External Examiner

ABSTRACT

KAALAM is a short film that explores the themes of friendship, time, loss, and the human tendency to postpone meaningful moments with the people who matter most.

The story follows a girl who experiences an unexpectedly pleasant day with her friend, who normally avoids meeting her. They travel together, visit a juice shop, spend time at a park, go shopping, and share childhood memories on a terrace. The day appears ordinary and cheerful. However, a sudden phone call at the end reveals that the friend is no more, forcing both the protagonist and the audience to reinterpret every moment they have just witnessed.

The film was shot using an iPhone 17 Pro Max with gimbal and tripod support. Post-production was completed using Adobe Premiere Pro for video editing, dialogue synchronization and audio editing, and Adobe After Effects for titles, text animations and visual effects. A professional microphone was used for dubbing and dialogue recording.

The project demonstrates the practical application of screenplay writing, cinematography, lighting, sound design and video editing techniques. The film relies on emotional storytelling and subtle foreshadowing rather than complex production resources, showing that an effective short film can be produced with simple equipment and everyday locations.

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PRIYADHARSHINI S (231701040)

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that combines storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound, lighting and editing to communicate an idea or experience to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, making it important to develop a clear concept and use every scene effectively. Radio podcasting, on the other hand, communicates stories through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms require creativity, planning and effective storytelling.

The project titled "KAALAM" is a short film developed as part of the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course. The film is centred around friendship, time, postponed moments, and the realization that some opportunities do not come twice. The story begins like an ordinary, light-hearted day between two friends. An unexpected visit leads to an unplanned day filled with conversations, jokes, travelling, juice, photographs, shopping, childhood memories, and casual moments.

Nothing initially suggests that anything is wrong. However, the friend's unusual behaviour creates several small details that become meaningful only after the final revelation. The film ends with a sudden phone call that completely changes the audience's understanding of everything they have just witnessed.

The story explores how people often postpone spending time with those who matter, assuming there will always be another opportunity. The central message of the film is that time cannot always be taken for granted.

CHAPTER 2

PROJECT OVERVIEW

The main idea of KAALAM is to portray how an ordinary day between two friends can hold extraordinary emotional significance when seen in the light of an unexpected revelation. The first part of the film intentionally appears realistic and simple. The audience sees the two friends spending a casual day together and assumes that the story is about friendship and daily life. This familiar setting helps the audience connect with the characters.

After the day unfolds with travelling, juice, a park visit, shopping, and terrace conversations, the atmosphere changes suddenly when a phone call reveals that the friend is actually no more. The discovery completely transforms the audience's understanding of everything they have just witnessed.

The film uses simple locations, a small number of characters and easily available setups. This makes the project practical to produce while still allowing different film-making techniques to be demonstrated. The emotional power of the film comes from its storytelling rather than from expensive production resources.

CHAPTER 3

TITLE – KAALAM

The title KAALAM represents time and the limited moments we have with the people around us.

Throughout the film, time is an important underlying element. The friend who normally avoids meeting her suddenly spends an entire day with her, fulfilling many of the simple things she has always wanted to do with him.

The title gains a deeper emotional significance after the climax, when the audience realizes that the day they have just witnessed may have been their final day together. The word KAALAM therefore functions on two levels: as a reference to the passing of time and as a reminder that time with the people we love is finite and uncertain.

CHAPTER 4

GENRE

The film belongs to the drama and emotional mystery genre. The dramatic element is created by building an emotional connection between the audience and the two friends throughout the film. The story begins warmly and becomes progressively more emotional.

The mystery is maintained by not revealing the true nature of the friend's visit until the very end. The audience receives information at the same time as the main character. This creates emotional impact and encourages the audience to reinterpret the earlier scenes after the revelation.

The major emotional and suspense elements used in the film are:

- An unexpected visit from a friend who normally avoids meeting
- Unusual and generous behaviour
- Willingness to take photographs despite normally disliking them
- Nostalgic childhood memories shared on the terrace
- A sudden and shocking phone call
- The revelation that the friend is no more
- An open-ended conclusion

CHAPTER 5

OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an engaging short drama film using basic film-making techniques and a simple production setup. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera work, lighting, editing and sound can be combined to create a particular mood and emotional response.

The specific objectives are:

- To develop an original short-film story.
- To understand screenplay and scene development.
- To practice camera framing and shot composition.
- To use lighting to establish mood.
- To create emotional impact through editing and sound.
- To develop basic video editing skills using Adobe Premiere Pro and After Effects.
- To understand the importance of background music and sound effects.
- To understand the difference between visual and audio storytelling.

CHAPTER 6

STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story was developed around the simple idea of two friends spending a day together, where the true significance of the day is revealed only at the very end. The initial concept was kept simple so that the emotional impact could be developed gradually without requiring multiple complex locations or a large cast.

The first part establishes the characters and their normal dynamic. The friend's unexpected visit introduces a reason for curiosity without immediately revealing why. Once the day unfolds through various casual activities, the audience becomes comfortable with the lighthearted tone.

The final part was developed to deliver the emotional revelation in a single moment. The phone call provides the shocking information. The earlier scenes then take on a completely different meaning. The unusual behaviour, the generosity, the photographs, and the childhood memories all become significant in retrospect.

CHAPTER 7

STORY SYNOPSIS

The film begins with a girl spending an ordinary day at home. She is casually watching television when she suddenly hears someone knocking at the door. When she opens the door, she is surprised to see her friend standing there.

His unexpected visit immediately catches her attention because he is normally the kind of person who rarely comes to meet her, even when she invites him. She questions him about why he suddenly came. He casually responds that since she did not invite him, he decided to come anyway. The interaction remains light and humorous. He then suggests that they go outside.

While travelling, the girl teases him about his usual behaviour, reminding him that even if she calls him repeatedly, he rarely answers. They eventually stop at a juice shop, where the friend surprisingly pays for both of them. They then visit a park where the friend unexpectedly takes photographs and posts them on social media, which is unusual for someone who normally dislikes this.

They continue their day together with shopping before returning home. On the terrace, they talk about childhood memories. The friend brings up an incident from their third standard when their teacher scolded the girl after finding a fantasy book in her bag. He reveals that the book was actually his and that he had secretly placed it inside her bag.

After some time, the friend asks for water. The girl goes downstairs. While she is away, her phone begins ringing repeatedly. When she finally answers, the caller asks about BK. After a pause, the caller says that BK is no more. The girl is shocked. She looks at the juice bottle in her hand and slowly looks towards the terrace.

The film cuts to black.

CHAPTER 8

CHARACTERS

The main character of the film is a young girl who spends most of the story interacting with her friend during what appears to be a normal day. She is initially cheerful, playful and curious about her friend's unexpected visit. Her emotional state changes dramatically during the final phone call. Her expressions and reactions are important because the audience understands the significance of the revelation mainly through her behaviour.

The second character is her friend (BK) who arrives unexpectedly and spends the entire day with her. His behaviour throughout the day is subtly different from his usual self. He is more generous, more willing to take photographs, more open about memories, and more present in every moment. These differences become meaningful only after the audience learns that he is no more.

The third presence is the phone caller who delivers the news about BK. This character is heard only through the phone call and serves as the narrative device that triggers the climax and the audience's reinterpretation of the entire film.

CHAPTER 9

SCENE DEVELOPMENT

9.1 Scene 1 – The Unexpected Visit

The first scene introduces the main character at home, casually watching television. The doorbell or knock interrupts her routine. She opens the door and is surprised to find her friend standing there. This scene establishes the normality of the setting and creates the initial curiosity about why the friend has arrived unexpectedly.

9.2 Scene 2 – Travelling

The two friends leave the house and travel together. During the journey, the girl teases him about his usual behaviour of ignoring her calls and messages. She jokingly points out how strange it is that he has appeared without being invited. The conversation remains casual and humorous, establishing their friendship dynamic.

9.3 Scene 3 – Juice Shop

They stop at a juice shop where the friend surprisingly pays for both drinks. The girl is amused because this is unlike his normal behaviour. This small moment of generosity becomes significant after the final revelation.

9.4 Scene 4 – Park

They visit a park and spend time together, talking and joking. The friend unexpectedly takes photographs and posts them on social media. This surprises the girl because he normally becomes irritated whenever someone takes pictures. This willingness to capture moments becomes another subtle indication that something about him is different today.

9.5 Scene 5 – Shopping

The two friends go shopping together. The sequence remains light-hearted, showing their friendship through small conversations and playful moments. The audience sees the day as nothing more than an unexpectedly enjoyable outing. They later decide to return home.

9.6 Scene 6 – Terrace

On the way back, the friend asks if they can go to the terrace. They sit together and talk about childhood memories. The friend brings up an incident from their third standard when their teacher scolded her after finding a fantasy book in her bag. He reveals that the book was actually his and he had secretly placed it there. This creates a humorous and nostalgic moment. After some time, the friend asks for water and the girl goes downstairs.

9.7 Scene 7 – The Phone Call

While downstairs, the girl's phone begins ringing repeatedly. She eventually answers. The caller mentions BK and, after a pause, reveals that BK is no more. The girl's expression changes immediately. She is shocked, looks at the juice bottle in her hand, and slowly looks towards the terrace. The film cuts to black.

9.8 Scene 8 – The Revelation

The audience is left questioning everything they have witnessed. Who was the person she spent the entire day with? Why did he suddenly appear? Why was he behaving differently? Why did he pay for her juice? Why did he take photographs? Why did he bring up childhood memories? And most importantly: who was actually with her on the terrace? The film deliberately does not provide a direct explanation, allowing the audience to interpret the supernatural or emotional significance of the final revelation.

CHAPTER 10

CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax occurs during the phone call when the girl learns that BK is no more. This single piece of information transforms the meaning of every scene that preceded it. The audience realizes that every unusual behaviour, every generous gesture, and every nostalgic conversation was potentially the friend's way of spending one final day with her.

The ending is intentionally open-ended. The film does not explain whether the friend's presence was supernatural, a final goodbye, or an emotional interpretation of events. This allows the audience to create their own understanding of the story. The uncertainty and emotional weight are important parts of the viewing experience.

The moral of the story is delivered through the experience rather than through dialogue:

"We keep saying 'later' to the people who matter, until there is no later."

CHAPTER 11

KEY THEMES

The film explores several interconnected themes that become apparent after the final revelation:

- Time – The limited and uncertain nature of the time we have with people.
- Friendship – The depth and value of genuine friendships.
- Postponement – The habit of putting off spending time with those who matter.
- Regret – The pain of realizing that missed opportunities cannot be recovered.
- Unspoken wishes – The things we want to say or do but keep delaying.
- Unexpected moments – How unplanned experiences can become the most meaningful.
- Loss – The impact of losing someone without warning.
- The value of relationships – How ordinary moments become extraordinary in retrospect.
- Taking people for granted – The assumption that there will always be another day.

The film emphasizes how ordinary moments can become incredibly valuable when they are no longer possible.

CHAPTER 12

STORY STRUCTURE

Beginning — The Unexpected Visit

The girl is having an ordinary day at home when her friend unexpectedly arrives. His sudden visit establishes that something is different without immediately revealing why.

Middle — The Unplanned Day

The two friends spend the day together. They travel, have juice, visit a park, take photographs, go shopping, talk about childhood memories, and spend time together. The tone remains casual, humorous, and friendly.

Final Act — The Revelation

The friend asks for water. The girl goes downstairs. Repeated phone calls lead to a conversation that reveals that BK is actually dead. The film cuts to black immediately after her realization. The audience is left to reinterpret every earlier scene in light of the revelation.

CHAPTER 13

CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography is used to control how the audience sees the story. During the first part of the film, normal camera shots are used to create a realistic and natural atmosphere. As the story reaches the climax, closer and more intimate shots are introduced.

The short film was shot using an iPhone 17 Pro Max, allowing the production to achieve a cinematic visual quality while maintaining a practical and flexible shooting setup.

A gimbal was used to achieve smooth and stable moving shots, particularly during travelling and outdoor sequences. A tripod was used for stable compositions and static shots where camera movement was unnecessary.

Close-up shots are particularly useful for showing the phone screen, facial expressions and important objects such as the juice bottle. Over-the-shoulder shots are used during conversations. The camera remains stable during normal scenes to reinforce the casual tone.

CHAPTER 14

LIGHTING AND VISUAL APPROACH

The film intentionally begins with a natural and realistic visual style. The early scenes are designed to feel like an ordinary day between two friends. The camera work is therefore kept natural rather than immediately presenting the film as a supernatural or emotional drama.

Lighting plays an important role in creating the mood of the film. The outdoor scenes use natural daylight to maintain a cheerful and ordinary atmosphere. The terrace scene uses softer, warmer lighting to create a more intimate and personal feeling.

The gimbal provides smooth movement during travelling and outdoor sequences, while the tripod provides stable compositions during important conversations. The visual language gradually becomes more meaningful as the story progresses. After the final revelation, the audience can reinterpret many of the earlier visual moments differently.

CHAPTER 15

SOUND DESIGN AND DUBBING

A professional microphone was used for dialogue and dubbing to achieve clearer and more controlled audio. The recorded audio was subsequently edited and synchronized during post-production using Adobe Premiere Pro.

Sound plays an important role in the final phone-call sequence. The transition from a casual conversation to the shocking revelation creates the emotional impact of the ending. The sudden cut to black after the girl's realization leaves the audience with unanswered questions and allows the ending to remain open to interpretation.

Important sound elements include:

- Natural ambient sounds during outdoor scenes
- Casual conversation and laughter
- Phone ringtone and vibration
- Background music that supports the emotional tone
- The caller's voice during the revelation
- Silence used deliberately before and after the revelation
- The abrupt ending with no closing music

CHAPTER 16

EDITING AND POST-PRODUCTION

The film was edited using Adobe Premiere Pro. Premiere Pro was used for:

- Video editing
- Scene arrangement
- Cutting and transitions
- Dialogue synchronization
- Dubbing
- Audio editing
- Overall post-production

Adobe After Effects was used for:

- On-screen text
- Titles
- Text animations
- Visual text elements
- Additional post-production effects

The combination of Premiere Pro and After Effects was used to create the final visual and audio presentation of the film.

CHAPTER 17

USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

The project is designed to be produced using simple locations and easily available props. The main locations include the girl's home, a road or pathway for the travelling scene, a juice shop, a park, a shopping area, and the terrace of the house.

The major props required are:

- Mobile phone
- Juice bottles
- Shopping bags
- Household items for the home scenes
- Terrace furniture or seating

The limited number of props and the use of everyday locations make the film practical to shoot while allowing the focus to remain on the characters, their interactions, and the emotional storytelling.

CHAPTER 18

INTENDED AUDIENCE EXPERIENCE

The film is designed to initially make the audience believe that they are watching a simple story about two friends spending an unexpectedly enjoyable day together. The audience is not expected to immediately understand the deeper meaning behind the friend's unusual behaviour.

Only after the final phone call should the audience begin reconsidering the earlier scenes. The unexpected visit, juice, photographs, shopping, childhood memory, terrace conversation, and other small moments can all take on a different meaning after the revelation.

The emotional impact is strongest when the audience realizes that every generous and unusual action by the friend was potentially a farewell. The open-ended conclusion allows each viewer to interpret the events according to their own understanding and emotional response.

CHAPTER 19

PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production of the project can be divided into three stages: pre-production, production and post-production.

During pre-production, the story idea was developed and converted into a screenplay. The scenes, characters, locations, props and required sound elements were identified. The emotional arc of the film was carefully planned so that the casual tone of the earlier scenes would contrast with the emotional weight of the climax.

During production, the scenes were recorded according to the screenplay. Different camera angles were captured using the iPhone 17 Pro Max with gimbal and tripod support. Outdoor scenes, indoor scenes, and the terrace conversation were recorded separately. Voice recordings and dialogue were captured using a professional microphone.

During post-production, the recorded footage was organized and edited using Adobe Premiere Pro. Scene arrangement, cutting, transitions, dialogue synchronization, dubbing, and audio editing were completed. Adobe After Effects was used for titles, text animations, and visual effects. The final video was exported after checking the complete sequence.

CHAPTER 20

CHALLENGES FACED

One of the major challenges in producing this film was maintaining the balance between a casual, lighthearted tone and the emotional weight of the final revelation. The early scenes needed to appear genuinely normal so that the ending would have maximum impact.

Another challenge was conveying the friend's subtle differences in behaviour without making them too obvious. The audience should not suspect the ending but should be able to recognize the clues when rewatching the film.

Shooting across multiple outdoor locations with natural lighting required careful planning to maintain visual consistency. Audio synchronization between dubbed dialogue and on-screen actions was another important challenge that required attention during post-production.

CHAPTER 21

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, several practical skills were developed. The project provided experience in screenplay writing, scene planning, camera operation, lighting, acting, sound recording and video editing.

The project also demonstrated the importance of emotional storytelling and how subtle details can carry significant meaning when revealed in retrospect. The use of foreshadowing through small behavioural changes was an important narrative technique explored during the development of this film.

The editing process using Adobe Premiere Pro and After Effects provided hands-on experience with professional video editing tools. The project demonstrated that an effective short film does not necessarily require complex production resources but depends more on the strength of the story and its emotional connection with the audience.

CHAPTER 22

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The final outcome of the project is a short drama film titled KAALAM. The film is expected to engage the audience through a gradual transition from a casual, everyday friendship outing to a deeply emotional and thought-provoking revelation.

The project demonstrates the practical use of visual storytelling, sound design and editing techniques. The open-ended conclusion allows the audience to think about the possible meaning of the events and the value of the time they spend with the people they care about.

The one-line story of the film is:

"What begins as an ordinary day with a friend becomes a memory she never knew would be their last."

CHAPTER 23

CONCLUSION

The KAALAM project demonstrates how a simple story can be developed into a deeply emotional film through effective use of film-making techniques. The story begins with an ordinary day between two friends and gradually builds towards a revelation that transforms the meaning of every earlier scene.

The project combines screenplay writing, acting, cinematography, lighting, sound design and video editing. Each element contributes to the overall emotional impact of the film. The use of simple locations and limited characters demonstrates that an effective short film does not necessarily require complex production resources.

KAALAM reminds us that we often postpone spending time with people who matter because we assume there will always be another day. But time is uncertain. Sometimes, the opportunity we keep postponing may be the opportunity we never get again.

"We keep saying 'later' to the people who matter, until there is no later."

APPENDIX



